

Wormhole

Refined product vision for a personal worldbuilding and story-management app

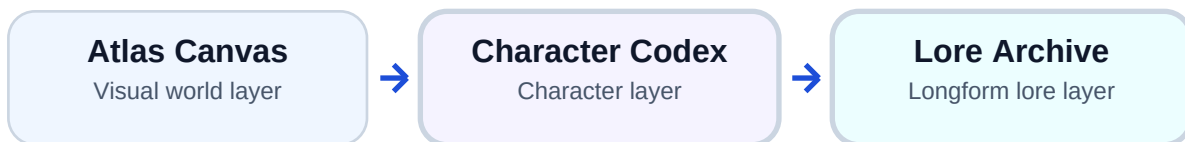
What this document is

This is not a build spec. It is the finished-picture version of the app: what Wormhole is, how its major systems work together, and what kind of experience it is meant to create.

Core idea

Wormhole is a personal universe explorer. Each wormhole is a separate world, story universe, or creative space. When a world is opened, the app should immediately make that world understandable through three connected systems: the world itself, the people inside it, and the longform lore behind it.

The app is easiest to understand through this 3-system structure:



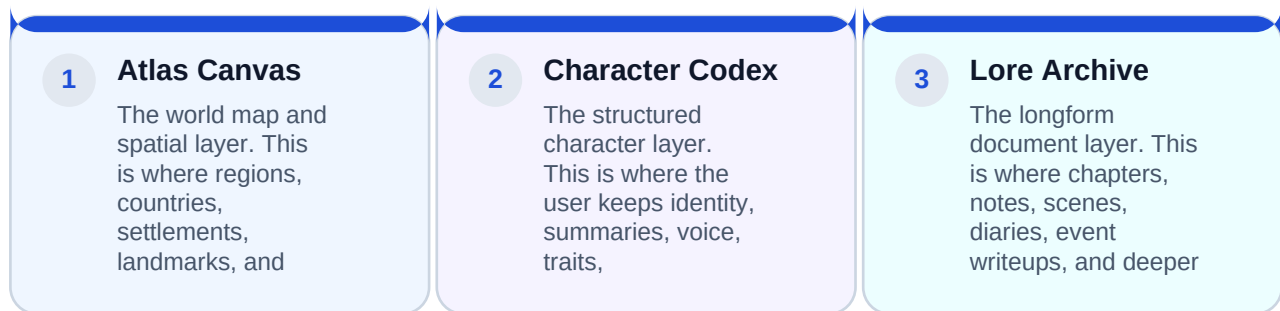
The names above are the cleanest framing for the product. Atlas Canvas is the spatial world layer, Character Codex is the structured people layer, and Lore Archive is the longform writing layer. These are separate systems, but they are designed to reinforce each other rather than feel like three disconnected tools.

How the app should feel

- **Readable first, expressive second.** The app should make a world understandable before it tries to make it flashy.
- **Structured, but not rigid.** The user should be able to express different kinds of worlds without being forced into a single generic template.
- **Local and personal.** Wormhole is designed around solo use, long-term maintenance, and the ability to keep building a world over time.
- **Immersive, not chaotic.** The point is to bring life to a world while keeping that world navigable.

The three-system model

The easiest way to absorb Wormhole is to think of it as one app composed of three major systems. Each system has a different job. The app works when each one is strong on its own and even better when they are linked together.



Why this structure matters

Without this structure, Wormhole becomes a vague 'creative everything app.' With it, the app becomes much easier to reason about: the world is explored visually in Atlas Canvas, people are understood through Character Codex, and deeper narrative material lives in Lore Archive.

What each system is responsible for

- **Atlas Canvas** answers: *What does this world contain, and where is it?*
- **Character Codex** answers: *Who matters in this world, and what do I need to know about them quickly?*
- **Lore Archive** answers: *Where do the deeper notes, stories, scenes, and records live?*

How they connect

- A country or landmark on the map can link to characters, notes, events, and lore documents.
- A character page can link back to regions, locations, diary pages, event documents, and related records.
- A lore document can mention or link to specific characters, places, and world elements.

System 1 — Atlas Canvas

Atlas Canvas is the world-facing system. It is the part of Wormhole that lets the user see the world itself rather than just read about it. It is not merely decoration. It is the visual entry point into the universe.

What Atlas Canvas is

A zoomable world canvas where meaningful places are represented as structured, clickable entities. The canvas can be visually expressive, but its main job is orientation: helping the user understand the world spatially.

How Atlas Canvas is structured

- **Visual layer.** The world can have a map image, drawn layout, or placed visual elements so the user has a sense of place.
- **Geographic layer.** Countries, regions, settlements, landmarks, buildings, and other meaningful places exist as structured records.
- **Narrative link layer.** Places can connect to characters, notes, events, arcs, and lore documents.

What belongs here

- Continents, countries, districts, settlements, landmarks, historical sites, and infrastructure that actually matter to the world.
- Decorative map objects such as trees, rocks, and visual markers may appear, but they remain lightweight and do not carry heavy app logic by default.
- Place-to-entity connections such as: ruler of, resident in, origin of, active in, tied to event in.

How the user experiences it

- The user opens a world and can move around the map through pan and zoom.
- Clicking a country, settlement, or landmark opens its detail panel instead of throwing the user into a generic note page.
- From each meaningful place, the user can jump to related characters and linked lore.

What Atlas Canvas is not trying to be

- Not a full geography simulator.
- Not a game map editor with every small object turned into a heavy data structure.
- Not a replacement for dedicated digital art software.

System 2 — Character Codex

Character Codex is the people-facing system. It turns a pile of character notes into readable, structured profiles that still leave room for personality and expression.

What Character Codex is

A structured character vault with a stable core, optional modules, and a limited freeform layer. The goal is to avoid both extremes: not a rigid spreadsheet, and not a chaotic page-builder.

Internal model of a character page

- **Layer A — Core profile.** Name, image, role, affiliations, key traits or tags, objective summary, quick links.
- **Layer B — Optional modules.** Relationships, locations, important events, arc notes, diary links, or other world-specific sections that can be enabled when needed.
- **Layer C — Expressive section.** A controlled freeform area for voice, flavor text, custom notes, or an in-character self-introduction.

Why this model fits Wormhole

- Different worlds do not need the exact same fields.
- The user should be able to hide irrelevant modules instead of being forced to stare at empty fields.
- The character still remains structured enough for search, filtering, comparison, and maintenance.

Important page elements

- A clear image and title card at the top of the character page.
- An objective summary that states who the character is plainly.
- An optional in-character paragraph that gives the page voice and immersion.
- Quick links to related lore, places, events, and other records.
- A purely decorative ribbon or accent marker for style, with no hidden app logic attached to it.

What Character Codex is not trying to be

- Not a fully custom layout editor for every character from day one.
- Not a visual design sandbox where the user spends more time arranging UI than building the world.
- Not a replacement for illustration or animation software.

System 3 — Lore Archive

Lore Archive is the longform writing system. It is where the deeper material lives: the notes, records, scenes, chapter-like pages, event documents, and story fragments that would be too heavy to force directly into the map or character interfaces.

What Lore Archive is

A folder-and-document based note system for longform lore. Its role is depth. The map and character systems show structured summaries; Lore Archive holds the fuller text behind them.

What belongs here

- World lore and background notes.
- Scene fragments, chapter documents, event writeups, timelines-in-text, and story snippets.
- Character diaries, letters, records, and deeper narrative material that should not bloat the core profile page.

How it behaves

- The user organizes documents through folders and subfolders.
- Documents can link to other documents, similar to internal note links.
- Structured records from the rest of the app can point into the archive through explicit quick links and related-record sections.

Why Lore Archive stays separate

- It prevents the character system from turning into a wall of text.
- It prevents the map system from carrying narrative overload.
- It creates a clear boundary between structured truth and longform writing.

What Lore Archive is not trying to be

- Not the hidden internal database for the app.
- Not just a dump folder for unorganized text.
- Not the only way to navigate the world.

How the three systems work together

Wormhole becomes powerful when the three systems are used together instead of in isolation. The map gives spatial understanding, the character system gives human understanding, and the lore system gives narrative depth.

A simple example flow

1. The user opens a world and starts on the world overview.
 - They click into Atlas Canvas and select a country.
 - The country panel shows a summary, linked characters, and linked lore.
 - They open one of those characters in Character Codex and read both the objective summary and the in-character introduction.
 - From that page, they jump to a diary entry or event document inside Lore Archive.
 - The app still feels like one connected universe because each system points naturally into the others.

Information principle

Structured facts should live in the structured systems. Longform writing should live in Lore Archive. Links should connect the layers, not blur them together.

Default navigation shape

- Home screen: world selection and world creation.
- Inside a world: a top-dock style navigation bar with sections such as Overview, Atlas Canvas, Character Codex, and Lore Archive.
- Overview acts as the landing page so the world feels like a place first, not a file system first.

The intended emotional effect

- Opening a world should feel like entering a private creative universe.
- The app should encourage depth and expression, but still feel calm and readable.
- The user should never feel like they are lost in a pile of disconnected notes.

Boundaries that keep the product healthy

- **No built-in sprite editor in the core app.** That would turn Wormhole into a second product.
- **No assumption that every visual object needs metadata.** Decorative items should stay decorative unless they matter.
- **No fully freeform page-building everywhere.** The app needs stable structure to remain useful long-term.
- **No confusion between documents and database records.** The lore archive is for writing; the app data layer is for structured truth.

Completed-picture summary

In its refined form, Wormhole is a local-first personal worldbuilding app built around three connected systems. Atlas Canvas lets the user explore the world spatially. Character Codex lets the user understand the people inside that world through structured but expressive profiles. Lore Archive holds the deeper text, story fragments, and longform material that give the universe depth. The whole app is designed around one guiding idea: expression with enough structure that the world stays meaningful, navigable, and alive.